CSE0001: Digital Literacy Project Report

Student Digital Ambassador

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Project Introduction

Digital literacy has become an essential pillar of modern engineering education, especially for a first-year B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal. It goes far beyond the basic ability to use a computer; it involves the critical skill of navigating, evaluating, and creating information using various digital technologies. In an era where cyber threats are evolving and professional networking has moved almost entirely online, staying digitally literate is no longer optional—it is a requirement for academic and career success.

In this project, I have taken on the role of a **Student Digital Ambassador**. My objective was to build a comprehensive digital portfolio that demonstrates my proficiency in five key modules: awareness, professional presence, technical collaboration, communication etiquette, and cybersecurity. Throughout this process, I established a professional footprint on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, practiced formal communication for academic and industry settings, and researched critical cybercrime prevention strategies. This report documents my journey in mastering these skills and serves as a roadmap for how I intend to maintain a safe, professional, and impactful digital presence throughout my four-year degree and beyond into my professional career.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness

For the first module, I was tasked with creating an infographic to spread awareness about digital literacy among my peers. I chose to use Canva because it allowed me to combine professional layouts with clear, engaging visuals. My primary goal was to show that being "digitally literate" isn't just about knowing how to use a laptop or a smartphone; it’s about critical thinking, verifying information, and protecting one's digital identity.

In the infographic, I highlighted three main pillars: safe internet practices, identifying fake news, and building a professional online presence. Designing this was a great learning experience because it forced me to condense complex security concepts into simple, actionable tips. I focused specifically on password hygiene and the importance of checking sources before sharing information on social media. This task helped me realize that as a B.Tech student, I have a responsibility to not only be tech-savvy but also to help others navigate the digital space safely. The final design is uploaded in my repository as a reference for anyone looking to improve their basic digital skills.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

In Task 2, I established my professional digital footprint by setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose these three platforms because they are the industry standards for engineering students. LinkedIn helps me connect with the professional world and the academic community at VIT Bhopal, while GitHub allows me to showcase my actual coding work and version control skills. I also joined Kaggle to start exploring the world of data science and competitive programming early in my degree.

Setting these up taught me the importance of maintaining a "clean" and professional digital identity. I learned how to write a professional bio and how to display my education details correctly to attract potential recruiters. I plan to use these platforms throughout my four years of B.Tech to document my projects, lab assignments, and certifications. By starting this process now in my first year, I am building a solid history of work that will be ready by the time I apply for internships or placements in the future.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration

Task 3 was designed to test our ability to use modern platforms for technical work and group collaboration. First, I used HackerRank to solve a basic coding challenge. This was my first time using an online judge, and it taught me how to read problem statements carefully and ensure my code passes multiple test cases. It was a good exercise in logic and helped me get comfortable with the environment I will likely use for technical interviews in the future.

For the second part of the task, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. I drafted five targeted questions to see how much my batchmates knew about topics like 2FA and phishing. I then linked the form to a Google Sheet to see how the responses are collected and organized in real-time. This showed me how cloud-based tools can make data collection and teamwork much faster and more accurate than traditional methods. Understanding these platforms is essential for my engineering degree, as most of our future group projects will involve collaborating through cloud services and sharing technical progress on coding platforms.

Task 4: Professional Communication

In this module, I focused on the "soft skills" side of digital literacy, which is often overlooked but critical for career success. I practiced writing two formal emails: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor and another inquiring about a summer internship opportunity. Drafting these helped me understand the importance of clear subject lines, formal greetings, and being concise yet respectful. It's a major shift from the casual way we usually communicate on platforms like WhatsApp or Discord.

I also developed a 10-point "Do's and Don'ts" checklist for social media behavior. This part of the task was particularly eye-opening because I had to think about how a recruiter might view a student's public profile years from now. I learned that our "digital footprint" is permanent, and even one unprofessional post can impact future job opportunities. By following the checklist I created, I feel more confident in managing my social media accounts in a way that supports my professional image rather than hurting it. This task has definitely made me more mindful about every email I send and every post I share online.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

For the final task, I researched the growing threat of UPI and QR code fraud, which is a significant issue for students in India today. My case study focused on a common scam where attackers trick victims into scanning a QR code to "receive" money, when in reality, scanning and entering a PIN only allows money to be sent. Writing this scenario helped me understand the psychological tricks scammers use, such as creating a false sense of urgency or pretending to be a legitimate buyer.

To help prevent such crimes, I compiled an 8-point safety checklist. This research was personally very useful as it introduced me to the National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930) and the official reporting portal. I realized that many people don't report these crimes because they feel embarrassed or don't know where to go for help. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I believe it's important to share this knowledge with my peers so they know exactly what to do if they are ever targeted. This task provided practical safety knowledge that I can apply to my daily life immediately to protect my finances and data.

Final Reflection / Conclusion

Completing this project as a Student Digital Ambassador has been a highly rewarding learning experience. Before starting this course, I used the internet mostly for entertainment and basic communication, but now I understand how to use it as a powerful professional tool. I've learned how to secure my accounts, communicate formally with faculty and recruiters, and build a digital portfolio that accurately reflects my technical skills.

This project has given me a significant head start on my career by helping me build a professional presence on GitHub and LinkedIn. Moving forward, I am much more confident in my ability to navigate the digital world safely and efficiently. I plan to keep my repository updated as I progress through my B.Tech journey at VIT Bhopal, using it as a living record of my growth as an engineer. Overall, this project has taught me that being digitally literate is a continuous process of learning and adapting to new technologies.

Key Links:

GitHub: https://github.com/
Canva: https://www.canva.in/
LinkedIn: https://in.linkedin.com/
HackerRank: https://www.hackerrank.com/
Kaggle: https://www.kaggle.com/